STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-4420	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **03/06/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES BUREAU OF ALCOHOL, TOBACCO, AND FIREARMS EXPLOSIVES INFORMATION DOCUMENT I 5400.01			
SUBJECT EXPLOSIVE DEVICES	CROSS REFERENCE P-3500 COMMUNICATIONS PROCEDURES P-4400 HAZARDOUS MATERIALS CS-3500 COURT HOUSE EMERGENCY PLANS J-4050 BOMB THREATS A-5800 ADMINISTRATION OFFICE EMERGENCY PLANS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for handling suspected explosive devices and the threatened use of explosive devices.

II. Policy:

The threat and use of explosive devices are employed in criminal activity. Whether an explosion occurs, or the threat of explosives is made, all Sarpy County Sheriff's Office deputies must be aware of the proper procedures to follow during these events to protect lives and property. Incidents involving explosive devices shall be separated into three categories: the threatened use of an explosive device (i.e. "bomb threat"), discovery of an actual or suspected explosive device, and the detonation of an explosive device. The Omaha Police Department's Bomb Response Team (BRT) shall be requested to assist with any suspected explosive device.

III. Procedures:

A. Threatened Use of an Explosive Device (Bomb Threat)-Communications Procedures:

1. Generally, a bomb threat call will be received by Communications as second hand information, and Communications will dispatch two deputies and the shift supervisor following normal procedures (see P-3500 Communications Procedures).

2. **Bomb Threat Received by Communications**: If Communications receives a bomb threat directly, the following procedures shall be implemented:

a) Communications shall gather all relevant information.

b) Communications will advise: "Attention all units, Signal 9, Go to LE Common 1 (or LE Common 2).

c) The call will then be dispatched.

d) Bomb threats received by Communications for the Court House, Jail or Sheriff's Administration Office shall be dispatched over all Sheriff's Office talkgroups and appropriate facility emergency plans shall be followed (see CS-3500 Court House Emergency Plans, J-4050 Bomb Threats, and A-5800 Administration Office Emergency Plans.)

B. Threatened Use of an Explosive Device (Bomb Threat)-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. The responding deputies should attempt to gather as much information regarding the threat to determine the credibility of the threat. Threats containing the following information are deemed to be more credible:

a) A specific location for the explosive device.
b) A specific detonation time.
c) A specific target individual or organization.
d) A specific description of the explosive device.
e) A specific grievance or purpose for the threat.

2. The responding deputy shall contact the individual responsible for the building and, based on the credibility of the threat listed above, shall determine the need for evacuation.

3. **Search Procedures:** A search shall only be conducted with permission from the shift supervisor and adhering to the following procedures:

a) A search may be conducted if there is a reasonable amount of time prior to the threatened detonation time.

b) No search shall be conducted near or immediately following the threatened detonation time. A minimum of thirty (30) minutes shall elapse after the threatened time before a search may be conducted.

c) Portable radios shall not be used in or near the threatened location.

d) Deputies should begin searching in areas readily accessible to the public.

e) When a credible threat exists that an explosive device is within a vehicle, deputies shall not search that vehicle, but shall evacuate the area surrounding the vehicle.

4. The initial assigned deputy shall complete an incident report.

C. Threatened Use of an Explosive Device (Bomb Threat)-Supervisor Responsibilities: The shift supervisor shall respond to all bomb threat calls. If the shift supervisor determines the threat to be credible, he or she shall adhere to the following procedures:

1. The shift supervisor shall establish a field command post at a safe distance from the location (see Minimum Safe Distance Chart below).

2. The shift supervisor shall notify the watch commander or the ADC.

3. If necessary, the shift supervisor shall request emergency fire and rescue respond.

4. The shift supervisor may request Communications contact Offutt Air Force Base and request assistance from their Bomb K-9 Unit.

5. The shift supervisor shall recommend evacuation to the property owner. The property owner has the ultimate decision on evacuation if no device has been located.

6. The shift supervisor shall determine the need for a search of the location based on the credibility of the threat and the amount of time available prior to the threatened detonation time.

a) If a device is discovered, the Suspected Explosive Device (section D) procedures shall be followed.

b) If no device is discovered after a search, the property owner shall be advised that a device was not found and he or she shall be responsible for the decision to return to the location.

7. The shift supervisor may request the on-call investigator to assist with the investigation.

D. Suspected Explosive Device-Deputy Responsibilities: If a deputy discovers a suspected explosive device, he or she shall adhere to the following procedures:

1. The deputy shall immediately evacuate all civilians to a safe distance (see chart below).

2. The deputy shall notify the shift supervisor and Communications of the discovery; the deputy should not use his or her portable radio or any other electronic device within 100 yards of the device.

3. Deputies shall not move or tamper with any suspected explosive device.

4. Deputies should prevent anyone from re-entering the location.

5. The initial assigned deputy shall complete an incident report.

6. For the purpose of this SOP, ammunition (.50 caliber or less), common fireworks, and related items (e.g. reloading supplies) shall not be considered explosive devices (see P-4400 Hazardous Materials).

E. **Suspected Explosive Device-Supervisor Responsibilities:** The shift supervisor shall respond to all incidents of suspected explosive devices.

1. The shift supervisor shall establish a field command post at a safe distance from the location (see Minimum Safe Distance Chart below).

2. The shift supervisor shall establish an outer perimeter to prevent civilians from entering the danger zone.

3. The shift supervisor shall ensure appropriate evacuation has been completed.

4. The shift supervisor shall notify the watch commander or the ADC.

5. If necessary, the shift supervisor shall request emergency fire and rescue respond.

6. The shift supervisor shall request Communications contact the Omaha Police Department's Bomb Response Team and request they respond to the scene.

7. The shift supervisor shall assist the Bomb Response Team as requested.

8. The shift supervisor may request the on-call investigator to assist.

F. **Detonation of an Explosive Device-Deputy Responsibilities:** If an actual explosion occurs, the following procedures shall be followed:

1. Responding deputies shall treat the location as a crime scene and remain alert for secondary explosions from:

a) Additional devices.
b) Explosive gases, liquids, or chemicals.
c) Undetonated explosive debris.

2. Responding deputies shall ensure all individuals are evacuated and any injured persons receive appropriate medical treatment.

3. The initial assigned deputy shall complete an incident report.

G. **Detonation of an Explosive Device-Supervisor Responsibilities:** The shift supervisor shall respond to all incidents where an explosive device has been detonated.

1. The shift supervisor shall establish a field command post.

2. The shift supervisor shall establish an outer perimeter to prevent civilians from entering the crime scene.

3. The shift supervisor shall ensure appropriate evacuation has been completed.

4. The shift supervisor shall notify the watch commander or the ADC.

5. If necessary, the shift supervisor shall request emergency fire and rescue respond.

6. The shift supervisor may request Communications contact the Omaha Police Department's Bomb Response Team if he or she believes there may be additional devices on scene.

7. The shift supervisor shall assist the Bomb Response Team as requested.

8. The shift supervisor shall request the on-call investigator respond to the scene.

9. The shift supervisor may request representatives from utility providers respond if disruption in service has occurred.

Minimum Safe Distance Chart:

The following chart is a guideline only. Distances may need to be increased due to additional explosive, toxic, or flammable materials near the device.

THREAT DESCRIPTION	EXPLOSIVES CAPACITY [1] (TNT Equivalent)	BUILDING EVACUATION DISTANCE [2]	OUTDOOR EVACUATION DISTANCE [3]
Pipe Bomb	5 LBS 2.3 KG	70 FT 21 M	850 FT 259 M
Briefcase or Suitcase Bomb	50 LBS 23 KG	150 FT 46 M	1,850 FT 564 M
Compact Sedan	500 LBS 227 KG	320 FT 98 M	1,500 FT 457 M
Sedan	1000 LBS 454 KG	400 FT 122 M	1750 FT 534 M
Passenger Van or Cargo Van	4,000 LBS 1814 KG	640 FT 195 M	2,750 FT 838 M
Small Moving Van or Delivery Truck	10,000 LBS 4,536 KG	860 FT 263 M	3,750 FT 1,143 M
Moving Van or Water Truck	30,000 LBS 13,608 KG	1,240 FT 375 M	6,500 FT 1,982 M
Semi Trailer	60,000 LBS 27,216 KG	1,570 FT 475 M	7,000 FT 2,134 M

1 — Based on the maximum volume or weight of explosive (TNT equivalent) that could reasonably fit in a suitcase or vehicle.
2 — Governed by the ability of an unstrengthened building to withstand severe damage or collapse.
3 — Governed by the fragment throw distances or glass breakage/falling glass hazard distance. Note that pipe and briefcase bombs assume encased charges which throw fragments farther than vehicle bombs.
Source: BATF